

Vasilika Papa

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Portfolio: vasilikapapa.dev | GitHub: github.com/vasilikapapa | LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/vasilika-papa

Full stack software engineer driven by curiosity about how things work and how to make them work better, with hands-on experience building and deploying web applications using React, TypeScript, Java, and Spring Boot. Strong foundation in REST APIs, relational databases, and cloud deployment, with a focus on clean architecture and user-centered design. Thrives on collaborative teams where feedback is welcomed and everyone learns from one another.

Technical Skills

Languages: Java, C#, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, HTML, CSS

Back End: Spring Boot, ASP.NET MVC (.NET), REST API design, Spring Data JPA, authentication

Front End: React, React Native (Expo), responsive design, reusable component architecture

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Azure Database for MySQL, Prisma ORM, query optimization

Cloud & DevOps: Azure, Docker, Vercel, Render, Git, GitHub

Tools & Practices: Postman, Agile/Scrum, code reviews, debugging

Software Engineering Experience

GBCS Group · Remote (Calgary, AB, Canada) · Mar 2024 – Oct 2024

Full Stack Developer Intern · Jul 2024 – Oct 2024

Back End Developer Intern · Mar 2024 – Jul 2024

- Promoted from back-end to full stack developer after four months while building a proposal management platform
- Designed and implemented REST APIs and integrated them with the front end
- Migrated the application database from Firebase to Azure Database for MySQL using Prisma ORM, and optimized SQL queries
- Shipped features in Agile sprints with daily standups and peer code reviews

Back End Developer Intern — One Albania · Tirana, Albania · May 2019 – Aug 2019

- Developed back-end features for a web application in C# using ASP.NET MVC on the .NET framework
- Implemented controllers, models, and views following the Model-View-Controller pattern, and debugged and tested code with the development team

Projects

Portfolio Roadmap Tracker — Java, Spring Boot, React, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, Docker

- Built a full-stack project tracking platform with a Spring Boot REST API and a React/TypeScript front end
- Implemented user authentication and an admin mode for editing projects and posting updates
- Containerized with Docker and deployed the API to Render and the UI to Vercel, backed by PostgreSQL

Restaurant Web App — React, TypeScript

- Built a responsive restaurant site with a dynamically rendered menu and API integration, designed for accessibility and mobile use

Workout Tracker Mobile App — React Native, Expo

- Built a workout tracking app with structured training plans and simple navigation, tested on physical devices via Expo Go

Portfolio Website — React, TypeScript

- Designed and deployed a personal portfolio on Vercel built from reusable UI components

Additional Experience

Mathematics Tutor — St. Louis Community College · St. Louis, MO · Jan 2025 – Aug 2026

- Tutored college students in mathematics through worked examples and step-by-step problem solving
- Supported coursework and exam preparation, adapting explanations to each student's learning needs

Technical Support Specialist (Part-Time) — Square · St. Louis, MO · Mar 2022 – Dec 2024

- Provided technical support for Square Point of Sale (POS) systems, troubleshooting hardware, software, connectivity, and transaction-related issues
- Diagnosed and resolved technical problems to help businesses keep their POS systems running smoothly
- Assisted users with system setup, configuration, and troubleshooting of POS devices and peripherals
- Investigated issues by identifying possible causes and guiding users through step-by-step solutions

Education & Training

A.A.S. Network Security Engineering — St. Louis Community College

M.S. Computer Science — University of Missouri–St. Louis

Full Stack Web Development Certificate (Java, Spring Boot, REST APIs) — LaunchCode

Bachelor's in Computer Engineering — Polytechnic University of Tirana, Albania